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» ADITI ASHOK, 25, GOLF, INDIVIDUAL AND TEAM

The last time Aditi Ashok competed at the Asian Games, she was a 17-year-old amateur golfer. The Bengaluru girl heads to Hangzhou as a world rank #48. Two years back, she had the nation spellbound with her inspiring showing in Tokyo, where she narrowly missed a medal. Part of India's seven-member Games contingent, five of whom come from Karnataka, Aditi has been in good form on the LPGA tour circuit, playing 17 tournaments in 21 weeks. "I've had a few great weeks this season and, hopefully, my preparation and practice will help me put together four good rounds to have a podium finish," she says.

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Women's golf will be a particularly competitive event, with some of the world's best from South Korea and China vying for a medal. But Aditi is unfazed by the challenge they pose and the weight of the occasion too. "Golf, interestingly, is a sport where rankings don't always correlate to the results," says Aditi, who was ranked 200 during the Tokyo Games. "Any golfer who puts together four good rounds can win, whether amateur or professional, highly-ranked or not... My goal is to play it like any other golf tournament and do my best."